

Hindi Ki Neev

हिन्दी की नींव

School Policies & Parent Guide · 2025–26

About Hindi Ki Neev

How long has Hindi Ki Neev been in operation?

HKN was founded in 2021, though our curriculum has been in use since 2016, starting at the Shiv-Durga Temple in Sunnyvale. Since our beginnings, we have taught around 500 students.

Is HKN a nonprofit?

Yes, Hindi Ki Neev is incorporated as a nonprofit organization under Section 501(c)(3), dedicated to teaching Hindi to children between the ages of 5 and 14 in the San Francisco Bay Area. Please note that enrollment fees are not a donation — they cover Hindi language instruction services and are not tax-deductible.

What is the school's mission?

Our mission is to teach Hindi as a second language to children and connect them with India's rich social, cultural, and traditional heritage. We serve students from all over the Bay Area, with a majority from Campbell, Cupertino, San Jose, Fremont, Santa Clara, Milpitas and Sunnyvale.

Enrollment

Is my child eligible to enroll?

Your child is eligible if they are at least 5 years old on August 1 of the year you are registering, and entering kindergarten or above. Children up to age 14 may enroll.

When does enrollment begin?

New students are admitted only in the Fall. If you have previously submitted an interest form on our website, you will receive an email in late July or early August inviting you to complete enrollment and pay fees. Only students on the Fall session roster are admitted to Winter and Spring sessions.

What is the enrollment process?

Once your interest form is submitted, we will verify eligibility and send you an invitation to complete the Enrollment Form. After we receive your completed form and verify payment via Zelle, we will assign your child a teacher and class time and send a confirmation email. You can also check your child's status through our school portal at portal.hindikineev.org.

What are the fees and what do they cover?

The annual enrollment fee, collected in July–August, covers tuition and books for the entire academic year (Fall, Winter, and Spring sessions). HKN is a nonprofit and aims to keep fees as low as possible. Our teachers are volunteers, but we must cover room rental, curriculum, administrative, and publishing costs.

Do you offer a free trial?

We do not offer free trials. However, if after the first class you decide not to continue for any reason, you may request cancellation within 24 hours and receive a full refund minus a \$25 processing fee. Refunds cannot be issued after 24 hours from the first class. This allows us to offer admission to another interested child.

Can my child start at a higher level?

Possibly. Please describe your child's Hindi background in the interest form, and send an email to info@hindikineev.org so we can discuss the appropriate placement. From experience, students who have not learned Hindi in a formal environment often have gaps that make higher levels challenging, so we take placement decisions carefully to ensure your child's success.

My child can speak Hindi but cannot read or write it — what level is recommended?

Students who can speak Hindi but have no reading or writing experience will start at Beginner-1. Reading and writing are foundational to our curriculum and your child will progress quickly given their speaking head start.

Classes

What is the class schedule?

Classes run from September to May, divided into three sessions of 10 classes each — Fall, Winter, and Spring — with holiday breaks. Each class is one hour long, held on Saturdays between 9:00 AM and 12:00 noon. Intermediate and Advanced classes are typically scheduled earlier; Beginner classes start later.

Where are classes held?

Classes are currently held at Little Champs, 5178 Moorpark Ave, San Jose, CA 95129 (West San Jose area). All classes are in person.

Is there any flexibility on timings or online options?

Class times are fixed. Occasionally a replacement class may be offered online, but this is rare. If your child misses a class, there are no separately scheduled make-up classes — students catch up with teacher guidance.

What is the class size?

Classes typically range from 5 to 15 students, with a maximum of 20 students per class.

Can parents observe the class?

We ask that parents wait outside during class. Research shows children learn languages more freely without parents present. At the teacher's discretion, parents may be permitted to attend the final 15 minutes of the first class. Please check with your child's teacher.

What if my child needs to be picked up late?

We request prompt on time pickups after class ends. We ask that you respect the time of our teachers and the safety of our students.

Curriculum & Levels

What curriculum and books are used?

Our curriculum is based on "Hindi Ki Duniya," a program developed at the Rishi Valley School by the Krishnamurthy Foundation of India. It is specially designed for non-native Hindi speakers and has proven highly effective in the US. All books are included in your enrollment fee.

How many levels does the program have?

HKN offers 9 levels across three stages — Beginner (Years 1–3), Intermediate (Years 1–4), and Advanced (Years 1–2). Please visit the Curriculum section at hindikineev.org for full details.

What will my child learn in their first year?

First-year students focus on the Hindi alphabet, colors, numbers, poems, and introductory conversation — covering reading, writing, speaking, and listening equally.

My child has no Hindi knowledge at all — is that okay?

Absolutely. Our program is designed from the very beginning for students with no prior Hindi knowledge.

How can a first grader and a fifth grader be in the same class?

We place students by Hindi level, not school grade. A child's age does not determine their Hindi level, and our teachers have materials and strategies to make learning engaging and appropriately challenging for each student individually.

What are the benefits of learning Hindi?

Beyond cultural connection, research shows that bilingual children develop superior problem-solving skills, enhanced creativity, stronger memory, better listening skills, and improved academic test scores. Learning to write in a second language is particularly beneficial for brain development.

Homework & Progress

How much homework is assigned?

Teachers assign approximately 30–60 minutes of homework per week, adjusted for the student's level. Beginner-level homework is primarily oral — reciting poems, listening to audio files, and practicing speaking for 10 minutes. Flashcard practice and workbook activities are also assigned. We do not overload students with written homework, especially at beginner levels.

What happens if my child misses too many classes?

If your child misses 50% or more of classes in a session, we may retain them at the same level for the following year. Consistent attendance is important — students who miss too many classes struggle to keep pace with the material, which can discourage their progress.

How can we support our child's learning at home?

We encourage parents to: speak Hindi at home as much as possible, supervise weekly homework especially for younger children, and play the audio poem files sent by the teacher regularly. Your involvement strengthens your child's progress and builds a wonderful connection between home and school.

What if my child loses or damages their book?

Please email info@hindikineev.org to request a replacement book.

Parent Responsibilities

We ask that parents help set their child up for success each week:

- Ensure your child brings all Hindi materials to every class: textbook, workbook, 2 sharpened pencils, an eraser, a small box of crayons, flashcards, and a notebook. Keep these organized in a dedicated Hindi bag.
- Students must bring a water bottle.
- Drop off and pick up your child on time.
- You will be added to the teacher's WhatsApp group for updates and school news.

- New parents: please attend Orientation Day (you will be notified by email) to meet the teacher and collect your child's books.
- Parents of new Beginner students: please stay in the proximity of Little Champs during the first few classes in case your child needs reassurance.
- Parent volunteers are always welcome. Our teachers occasionally need help with activities — please offer your time and support when you can.

Checking Your Child's Progress Online

Hindi Ki Neev now has a school portal where parents can view their child's enrollment status, attendance record, and teacher notes at any time.

 Visit the portal at: <https://portal.hindikineev.org/?intake=1>

How to look up your child's record

No account or password is needed. Simply visit the portal link above, then enter the following four details:

1. Parent or guardian name
2. Parent email address (the one registered with HKN)
3. Student first and last name
4. Student date of birth

Once your record is found, you will see:

- Your child's current enrollment status
- Assigned teacher and class time
- Class level and book
- Attendance record for the current session
- Notes left by your child's teacher

Teacher notes as a communication channel

Your child's teacher will leave notes on the portal after class as a lightweight weekly update on your child's progress. A note might say something like "Did well with reading today — needs more practice with verb conjugations." This is a direct window into your child's learning.

If you cannot find your child's record or have questions about your enrollment status, please email info@hindikineev.org